

GRACIAS POR INVITAR, LIVING PROJECT PORTAL, SPRINT 1

Business Strategy

The strategy-to-project chain: why this project earns the right to exist and what objective it serves.

Version0.1, Draft for team review, revised Sep 10, 2026

OwnerTo be assigned

TeamSamuel Alderete, Jazmin Huerta, Christian Lopez-Matulessy, Emmanuel Saenz, Oscar Vargas

CourseCS 4390/5388 Software Project Management, The University of Texas at El Paso, Fall 2026

Web<https://gpi-portal.onrender.com/sprint-1/business-strategy/>

DRAFT FOR TEAM REVIEW

The chain below is drafted from the Sprint 1 research. The business objective and its measures are the team's to set; a candidate framing is offered for comparison, not as a decision. The go/no-go recommendation belongs to the Sprint 2 business case and is the team's own work.

The chain in one view

LINK	GRACIAS POR INVITAR
Market signal	Events in El Paso are announced across dozens of social accounts; people hear about them from the people who happened to follow the right one, and often from the photos afterward.
Problem	People find out about events after they have already happened.
Opportunity	Nobody serves the whole city in one place. A weekly listing page used to, and participants still miss it.
Business objective	<i>Draft, below: become the place El Paso checks first for what is happening this week.</i>
Project	An events hub for El Paso: one listing, by date, from arena concerts to farmers markets and car meets.

LINK	GRACIAS POR INVITAR
------	---------------------

Success measures	<i>Draft, below.</i>
------------------	----------------------

Why this project earns the right to exist

The problem is real for a defined group. In Phase 2, six of twelve people described missing events they would have attended on a recurring basis, and seven of twelve, asked an open question about what they would change, asked for a single place to see what is coming. The people it fails hardest are the ones who rely on word of mouth and the ones with little or no social media. See the Market Research for the counts.

The incumbents are not built for this job. Instagram shows people what they already follow. Google returns places, not events. Ticketmaster covers big shows. FitFam is one account's curation, known to the people who know it. Each is good at its own job and none of them is a listing of what is happening in El Paso this weekend.

Demand for the specific shape has been demonstrated once already. One participant described a page that "would put all of the events that were going on every week," and that they used until it stopped. Another asked for "a weekly event round-up or calendar." The ask is not novel; it is unmet.

It is buildable by this team in a semester. The core is a listing with dates and categories, not a recommendation engine. The hard part is sourcing events, and that is a process and partnership problem the team can plan, not a technology the team cannot obtain (which is what stopped Candidate 5).

Who it serves first

1. **People who rely on word of mouth**, the largest group in the sample and the one with the strongest stories. Give them the thing they currently get from the friend who follows everything.
2. **People with little or no social media.** For them there is currently nothing except a sign by the road.
3. **Event organizers and venues**, who today advertise only to their existing followers. They are the supply side and the likeliest partners.

The heavy Instagram user with a curated feed is not the first customer. They are served well enough by what they have and they will judge the product against it.

The business objective

TEAM DECISION

Candidate framing for comparison, drafted from the research: *Within the semester, launch a public listing of events in El Paso that a defined group of residents checks weekly, measured by the number of events listed per week, the number of organizers submitting directly, and the share of visitors who return the following week.* The team sets the actual objective, its horizon and its numbers. Replace this box with the agreed objective.

Success measures (draft)

MEASURE	WHY IT MATTERS	TARGET
Events listed per week	The product is only useful if it is more complete than a feed	<i>Team to set</i>
Organizers submitting directly	Sustainable supply, not team curation forever	<i>Team to set</i>
Returning weekly visitors	The habit the product is trying to create	<i>Team to set</i>
Lead time of listed events	Participants asked for about a week	<i>Team to set</i>

How it could sustain itself

Not decided in Sprint 1 and not claimed here. The options the research points at, listed neutrally for the Sprint 2 business case: organizer listings (free basic, paid featured), sponsorship by venues or the city's tourism office, and promoted events. Each one depends on supply the team has not secured yet, which is why sourcing events is the first strategic risk below.

What would make the team stop

Kill criteria, so the go/no-go in Sprint 2 has something to test against:

- Events cannot be sourced reliably enough to be more complete than a good Instagram feed.
- Organizers will not submit, and manual curation by the team does not scale past the semester.
- Visitors do not come back the following week.

Strategic risks

RISK	EFFECT	FIRST RESPONSE
Sourcing: the listing is thinner than a curated feed	The product loses to the incumbent it is trying to replace	Start with a small number of categories and venues and be complete in those
Discovery: "how would people find out about the standardized way"	Nobody visits the hub	Distribution plan with organizers and the accounts people already follow
Scope creep toward Juárez, filters, notifications	The semester runs out before the listing exists	Charter scope boundary; Juárez is an open question, not a feature
A free incumbent adds a city-wide listing	The gap closes	Speed, and organizer relationships that a platform does not have

Links

- Market Research: the evidence behind every claim above.
- Project Charter: scope boundary, assumptions and stakeholders.

Generated from the portal source at build time. The web page and this PDF are two renders of the same document. Revision history: v0.1 (Sep 10, 2026) Structure and research-backed sections drafted; business objective pending team input.